Alabama Learning Hour

Ava's Animals: Class II Possession Review, Plural Possession

November 4, 2026

1 *Ava innaasi iyyi ostaakaha*

Ava innaasi iyyi ostaakaha

Ava's animals - Alabama Text

naasi iyyi ostaaka ava imiisafa lahwahchi.
iisahayon kati lochan, ifa hatkak iisahchi.
achan akaakak taɬɬaapin, aayampo kolokbifanɬaɬok nampobi.
yaɬaɬok laanahchi, ahkiɬaɬok okchakkohchi.
chassi imiisafan chichobon hiichali?
oh, waakoolo.
Avak hachonchoban bannati, maamin taatak waakan choopati.
ittofan sawak wiikahchi.
sawak Avan imbiniilihchi.
stanooko!

Ava's animals - English translation

There are a lot of animals at Ava's home.
In the house, a black cat and a white dog live.
Outside, there are five chickens, and in the bowl, there are many fish.
This fish is yellow, that fish is green.
Do I see a horse in the barn?
No, it is a cow.
Ava wanted an alligator, but dad bought a cow.
In a tree, the raccoon lives.
The raccoon visits Ava.
the end!

2 Vocabulary

Nouns

naasi iyyi ostaaka	animal
iisa	house
kati	cat
ifa	dog
akaaka	chicken
aayampo	dish
kolokbi	deep hole
aayampo kolokbi	bowl
ɬaɬo	fish
chassi imiisa	barn
chassi	corn
chichoba	horse
waaka	cow
hachonchoba	alligator
hachi	tail
choba	big
taata	dad
itto	tree
sawa	raccoon

Verbs

lahwa	to be many, a lot
nampo	to be many
iisa	to live at a place
hiicha	to see
banna	to want
choopa	to buy
wiika	to stay, be, live
imbiniili	to visit
anooka	to be gone, finished up

Adjectives

locha	black
hatka	white
laana	yellow
okchakko	green

Other

acha	outside
ta⫞⫞aapi	five
ya	this
ahki	that
maamin	but, however
stanooko	the end

3 Possession

- Last week we began to learn about possession
  - e.g. my cat, your cat
- To talk about possession, nouns need little pieces on the beginning to indicate who they belong to. We learned the difference between the Possessor (the one who possess) and the Possesse (that which is possessed)

(1) my friend
POSSESSOR POSSESSEE

- In Alabama, there are two separate set of prefixes used for different nouns.

(2) am + okla
my + friend
POSSESSOR

(3) cha + holchifa
my + name
POSSESSSOR

- Most nouns take am-Possessors (II), but some nouns, which often express kinship terms and body parts, take cha-Possessors (I)—they need to be remembered. Here are some of them:

Some nouns that take cha-Possessors (I)

- ifoni 'sister (of a man)'
- halki 'wife'
- ochoosi 'son, child'
- ostayki 'daughter'
- hachi 'tail'
- hissi 'hair'
- iyyi 'foot'
- sakba 'arm'

- If a noun is not on the special list, it takes an am-Possessor (type 2).
- We will say “my noun” by adding prefix am- to the noun, and we will say “your noun” by adding the prefix chim-. Note that chim- implies that you are addressing only one person.

Note: You can check which possession type a noun takes by checking the dictionary.

(14) [am + Noun]
my

(15) [chim + Noun]
your

- To say that this type of noun belongs to some third person (Ava, the child, dad), we put two nouns together:

(16) [POSSESSOR + im-Noun]
his/her

(17) [Ava + im-hissi]
Ava 's-hair

- Notice that all these little pieces we add end in [m]: am-, chim-, im-. When [m] is followed by a vowel ([i], [a], [o]), it is easy to pronounce.
- But when [m] is followed by a consonant—in particular, sounds like [t], [ch], [n], or [k], pronouncing two sounds in a row is a bit difficult. To help the speakers, Alabama changes [m] → [n] in such cases. For example:

(18) a. my basket: am + kolbi → an-kolbi
b. my cornbread: am + chakaawa → an-chakaawa
c. my man: am + naani → an-naani
d. my flour: am + tilko → an-tilko

Let's practice! How would you say the following in Alabama?

okla 'friend'

(19) a. my friend
b. your friend
c. Jacob's friend

taata 'dad'

(20) a. my dad
b. your dad
c. Jackson's dad

kati 'cat'

(22) a. my cat
b. your cat
c. Deb's cat

akaaka 'chicken'

(25) a. my chicken
b. your chicken
c. dad's (taata) chicken

ifa 'dog'

(23) a. my dog
b. your dog
c. baby's (aatosi) dog

naaɬiika 'language'

(26) a. my language
b. your language
c. Ava's language

- Now let's try putting these nouns into a sentence.

(27) [my/your-noun]-k [my/your-noun]-n hiicha-ti
-SUBJECT -OBJECT see-PAST

(28) am-okla-k chim-ifa-n hiicha-ti
my-sister-SUBJECT your-dog-OBJECT see-PAST
'My friend saw your dog.'

- Now, we will learn how to say that something is "our", "y'alls"', and "their"!

Possessives II Easy Recipe

[Possessor + Noun + Case]

Possessor Morphemes:

	Singular	Plural	
1	am- 'my'	kom-/pom- 'our'	1st person = speaker
2	chim- 'your'	hachim- 'y'all's'	2nd person = addresse
3	noun (e.g. Ava)	noun (e.g. children)	3rd person = someone else

(29)
a. am- + okla = amokla 'my friend'
b. chim- + okla = chimokla 'your friend'
c. Ava + okla = Ava okla 'Ava's friend'
d. kom-/pom + okla = komokla or pomokla 'our friend'
e. hachim- + okla = hachimokla 'y'all's friend'
f. poskoha + okla = poskoha okla 'children's friend'

(30) [kom/pom+Noun]
our

(31) [hachim-+ Noun]
y'all's

- To say that this type of noun belongs to some group of other people (the children, the parents, the deer), we put two nouns together:

(32) [POSSESSOR + Noun]
Their

(33) [Poskoha+ okla]
Children 's-hair

Let's practice! Using the animals we've been learning translate the following into Alabama! Remember to pay attention to the person and number!

kati 'cat'

(17)
a. our cat
b. y'all's cat
c. the children's cat

ifa 'dog'

(18)
a. our dog
b. ya'll's dog
c. the children's dog

ɬaɬo ‘fish’

(19) a. our fish
b. y’all’s fish
c. the children’s fish

hachonchoba ‘alligator’

(20) a. our alligator
b. y’all’s alligator
c. the children’s alligator

sawa ‘racoon’

(21) a. our racoon
b. y’all’s racoon
c. the children’s racoon

akaaka ‘chicken’

(22) a. our chicken
b. y’all’s chicken
c. the children’s chicken

iisa ‘house’

(23) a. my house
b. our house
c. the children’s corn

chassi ‘corn’

(24) a. their corn
b. y’all’s corn
c. Hector’s corn

Now let’s see how to use plural possessives in a sentence.

(27) [our/y’all’s/their -noun]-k [our/y’all’s/their-noun]-n hiicha-ti
-SUBJECT -OBJECT see-PAST

(28) kom-okla-k hachim-ifa-n hiicha-ti
our-sister-SUBJECT yall's-tail-OBJECT. See-PAST
‘Our sister saw y’all’s dog.’

Now let’s practice!

How would you say the following sentences in Alabama?

(29) a. Our cat saw y’all's dog.
b. Yall’s cat saw our dog.

(30) a. Our dad saw y’all's corn.
b. Yall’s dad saw our corn.

(31) a. Our chicken saw y’all’s house.
b. Yall’s chicken saw our house.